

Gennoor Tech

TRAIN. INNOVATE. BUILD.

GENNOOR ACADEMY · SELF-PACED ·
35 MIN

Demand Forecasting in Practice

A ~35-minute course for CSCOs, S&OP heads, demand planners — landscape, accuracy and the MAPE trap, model choice, demand sensing, promo uplifts, NPI, S&OP integration, 2-quarter rollout.

8

MODULES

35 min

DURATION

Intermediate

LEVEL

FREE

CERTIFICATE

Course Brief

DURATION	35 min · 8 modules · self-paced
FORMAT	Audio-narrated slide chapters with synchronized progress tracking. Interactive end-of-course Markdown builder you take to the next meeting. Free verifiable certificate on completion.
AUDIENCE	Chief Supply Chain Officers, S&OP heads, demand planners, supply chain analysts, operations finance.
PREREQUISITES	No technical prerequisites. The material is written for business decision-makers and assumes only general business literacy.

Course Outcomes

- 1 The honest landscape — M5 Forecasting Competition reality, where AI beats classical and where it doesn't
- 2 Accuracy and the MAPE trap — why FVA (Forecast Value Add) is the metric that matters
- 3 Model choice — when classical wins, when ML wins, when LLM-augmented wins
- 4 Demand sensing in practice — Coca-Cola / Unilever / Carrefour cases, 20-40% promo-week lift
- 5 Promotional + event uplifts — clean promo calendar + LightGBM uplift model + cannibalisation
- 6 New product introduction — P&G analog-product approach, ML does the math, judgement picks the analogs
- 7 S&OP integration — narrative + accountability, FVA analysis, the quote-or-cut rule against LLM hallucination
- 8 A 2-quarter rollout with 4 trust trip-wires — no unexplainable model, no unrecorded override, no unsourced AI narrative, no set-and-forget

Table of Content

8 modules · 35 min of audio-narrated learning · each module ends with a Monday-move you can apply that week.

MODULE 01

The forecasting landscape

~5 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- Gartner SCT25 2025: 78% have AI-in-forecasting initiative, 41% measurable lift.
- McKinsey: 15–30% MAPE reduction (top quartile), 30–50% top decile.
- M5 LightGBM domination, classical competitive on aggregates.
- SAP IBP/Oracle/Blue Yonder/o9/Kinaxis.
- Tetlock: calibration > confidence.

MODULE 02

Accuracy, bias, and the MAPE trap

~5 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- APICS 2024-25: median bias +5 to +12% (over-forecasting, structural).
- MAPE asymmetry — biased toward under-forecasting, catastrophic on intermittent demand.
- M5 used RMSSE.
- Use sMAPE/MASE/RMSSE by context.
- APICS: 1pp MAPE = \$0.5–1.5M per \$100M.

MODULE 03

Choosing the right model

~4 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- The 3-variable decision tree: history × signal × granularity.
- LightGBM for long-history granular, ETS/ARIMA/Theta for aggregated, Croston (or Croston-LightGBM hybrid, Boylan 2024) for intermittent, analog-lookup for short history.
- Ensemble for robustness.
- ML weak past 6 months.

MODULE 04

Demand sensing

~4 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- Blue Yonder + o9.
- POS, weather, ad spend, social signals. 5–15% MAPE reduction on 4-week horizon.
- Confidence-weighted overrides + cap on magnitude.
- Signal hygiene (POS latency, mapping) + FVA shadow-mode before production.
- Noise-chasing failure mode.

MODULE 05**Promotional & event uplifts**

~4 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- The lift · Coca-Cola · Unilever · Carrefour 2024-25
- The pattern · 3 components
- What breaks it · calendar drift
- The planner role · edge cases + FVA

MODULE 06**New product introduction**

~4 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- P&G NPI case via McKinsey 2024.
- Analog-product lookup + first-4-week early signal.
- Category expert picks analogs (judgement layer), ML does the math.
- Lock forecast for first 4 weeks, then re-tune. 3 buckets: analog-rich, analog-thin, genuinely novel.

MODULE 07**Connecting forecast to S&OP**

~5 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE

- SCC 2025: only 38% connect ML forecast to executive S&OP decisions.
- The gap is narrative + accountability.
- LokadTech 2025 LLM hallucination case (phantom promotion).
- FVA analysis (Gilliland/SAS) measures where in the chain accuracy is added or lost.
- Quote-or-cut for S&OP commentary.

MODULE 08**Making it stick: your demand-forecasting roadmap**

~4 MIN · NARRATED + INTERACTIVE · CAPSTONE BUILDER

- The principle · 2 not 7
- The sequence · default playbook
- Trust trip-wires · 4 hard nos

Taking This Further

The course is the starting point. The same content powers three concrete next steps you can engage Gennoor Tech to deliver inside your organisation:

4-week Pilot

- Fixed scope · fixed price · production artifact
- A working AI capability tied to the content of this course — set up on your data and tooling
- Suitable for: a single function or business unit ready to prove value

Org-wide Rollout

- 90-day adoption programme · executive + frontline tracks
- Champions network, prompt libraries, governance pack, weekly office hours
- Suitable for: 200-5,000-seat rollouts of Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, or similar

Continuous Build

- Quarterly retainer · embedded engineering + delivery + governance
- Multiple parallel AI initiatives sustained against an evolving roadmap
- Suitable for: large enterprises with portfolio-scale AI ambitions

Get in touch

Tell us about your AI ambitions, your team, and the constraints you are working under. We respond within one business day across India, GCC, SEA, US, and EU time zones.

enquiry@gennoor.com · www.gennoor.com · +91 · +971 · +1